

Health, Wellness and Sciences Centre

Honours Bachelor of Science – Nursing

Course Information

Course Title	Anatomy & Physiology 2
Course Code	NURS 1020
Course Hours	42

Faculty Information

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Georgian College Land Acknowledgement

Georgian College acknowledges that all campuses are situated on the traditional land of the Anishnaabeg people. The Anishnaabeg include the Odawa, Ojibwe, and Pottawatomi nations, collectively known as the Three Fires Confederacy. Georgian College is dedicated to honouring Indigenous history and culture and committed to moving forward in the spirit of reconciliation and respect with all First Nation, Metis and Inuit people.

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Course Description:

Students continue to explore the relationships between the body organ structures and functions with a focus in the learning of gross and microscopic anatomy. There is a special emphasis on the physiological adaptations that occur under special conditions.

Format: In-Class/Synchronous Online Theory**Core Content:**

- medical and nursing terminology in the context of healthcare settings
- gross and microscopic anatomy of major organ systems (e.g., cardiovascular, respiratory, digestive, renal, and reproductive)
- physiology of major organ systems (vide supra), including individual variations from the norm
- metabolism and nutrition
- fluid, electrolyte, and acid-base homeostasis

Course Learning Objectives:

Upon successful completion of this course, the student has reliably demonstrated the ability to:

1. Describe major organ systems and their function in the context of healthcare
2. Connect knowledge of anatomical structures to describe the physiologic function of each organ system through the principle of complementarity
3. Describe the interaction of the different organ systems to produce an integrated physiological response which sustains homeostasis
4. Explain how perturbations in the internal and external environments influence physiological process and function

Learning Objective	College of Nurses Entry to Practice Competency
Describe major organ systems and their function in the context of healthcare	1.21 – T, A, E
Connect knowledge of anatomical structures to describe the physiologic function of each organ system through the principle of complementarity	1.21 – T, A, E
Describe the interaction of the different organ systems to produce an integrated physiological response which sustains homeostasis	1.21 – T, A, E
Explain how perturbations in the internal and external environments influence physiological process and function	1.21 – T, A, E

Prerequisite(s): NURS 1016 – Anatomy and Physiology 1

Concurrent Prerequisite(s):

Required Text:

Betts, J. G., Desaix, P., Johnson, E., Johnson, J. E., Korol, O., Kruse, D., Poe, B., Wise, J. A., Womble, M. & Young, K. A. (2022) *Anatomy and Physiology* (2nd ed.). OpenStax.
<https://openstax.org/details/books/anatomy-and-physiology-2e>

Tests and Assignments

Test/Assignment	Percentage of final grade	Due Date	Learning Objective	CNO ETP Competency
Physiology Assignment Students will either perform or view several videos of physiological experiments related to the course content, obtain the relevant data, and write up a detailed assignment. The experiments will allow the students to learn core physiological principles. The students will interpret the lab data and formulate answers to the critical-thinking questions.	15	March 8, 2026, at 2359 (Assignment submission on Blackboard)	2, 3, and 4	1.21
Case Study Assignment A case study will be presented based on several key physiological concepts in the course. Critical thinking questions will be asked about the case study. Students will prepare a report that is based on discussing the questions posed by utilizing the knowledge and understanding gained from the course as well as exploring external peer-reviewed scientific literature.	10	April 5, 2026, at 2359 (Assignment submission on Blackboard)	2, 3, and 4	1.21

Quizzes: The online Blackboard quizzes will enable the students to consolidate their learning. The focus of the quizzes will be on the learning outcomes related to the weekly course content. Students will have an opportunity to identify areas of improvement through these formative assessments and remediate them through further practice.	10	Quiz 1 (Chapters 18 and 19): January 25, 2026, at 2359 Quiz 2 (Chapter 20): February 8, 2026, at 2359 Quiz 3 (Chapters 21 and 22): February 15, 2026, at 2359 Quiz 4 (Chapters 23 and 24): March 29, 2026, at 2359 Quiz 5 (Chapters 25, 26, and 27): April 12, 2026, at 2359	1, 2, 3, and 4	1.21
Mid-term Test: The mid-term test will assess the learning outcomes through the half-way point of the course. The format of the midterm will be a mix of NCLEX-style questions, regular MCQ, short answer questions, and a long-form essay-type question. Students will obtain constructive feedback from the test to reinforce their learning and develop more effective learning habits. The test also serves as a checkpoint for the students to self-evaluate their progress in the course and utilize the learning resources available at the college (e.g., student success	30	February 19, 2026, 2 h, in-person during class time (Chapters 18, 19, 20, 21, and 22)	1, 2, 3, and 4	1.21

services, writing centre, etc.).				
Final Exam: The comprehensive final exam will serve as a summative assessment that evaluates the meeting of the learning outcomes. The students will be provided with practice questions to self-evaluate and devise their own learning plans to meet the learning outcomes. The format of the final exam will be a mix of NCLEX-style questions, regular MCQ, and select-all-that-apply (SATA) questions.	35	Week 14 (Chapters 18 - 27)		
Total 100%				

Test and Assignment Descriptions

Please review the Assignments thoroughly so you understand the expectations for each assignment. Please bring any questions about assignments during class or make an individual appointment. Policies and procedure for assignments and exams can be found in your BScN Student handbook or online at [11. Tests and examinations < Georgian College Catalogue](#)

1. Title: Quizzes (on Blackboard)

Due Dates:

Quiz 1 (Chapters 18 and 19); Due Date: January 26, 2026, at 2359; 15 MCQ; 15 minutes

Quiz 2 (Chapter 20); Due Date: February 8, 2026, at 2359; 15 MCQ; 15 minutes

Quiz 3 (Chapters 21 and 22); Due Date: February 15, 2026, at 2359; 15 MCQ; 15 minutes

Quiz 4 (Chapters 23 and 24); Due Date: March 29, 2026, at 2359; 15 MCQ; 15 minutes

Quiz 5 (Chapters 25, 26, and 27); Due Date: April 12, 2026, at 2359; 15 MCQ; 15 minutes

Description: The quizzes will enable the students to consolidate their learning. The focus of the quizzes will be on the learning outcomes related to the weekly course content.

Instructions: Please click on the “Quizzes” link on Blackboard for further instructions. Each quiz will be a separate online link that you should click on to access. The format of the quiz is 15 multiple choice questions (MCQ) and there is a 15-minute time limit. The questions will be in NCLEX format. One question will be displayed at a time and backtracking is NOT permitted.

2. Title: Physiology Assignment (on Blackboard)

Due Date: March 8, 2026, at 2359 (on Blackboard)

Description: Students will view videos of several physiological experiments related to the course content, obtain the relevant data, and write a detailed assignment. The experiments will allow the students to learn core physiological principles. The students will interpret the lab data and formulate answers to the critical-thinking questions.

Instructions: Students will perform or view the physiological experiments and gather and record the relevant data. Students will then answer several questions that are posed in the lab assignment related to the conducted experiments. Students will submit their answers in

the form of an online assignment (in APA format) through the provided link. Further instructions will be provided in class as well as on Blackboard.

3. Title: Case Study Assignment

Due Date: April 5, 2026, at 2359 (on Blackboard)

Description: A case study will be presented based on several key physiological concepts in the course. Critical thinking questions will be asked about the case study. Students will prepare a report that is based on discussing the posed questions utilizing the knowledge and understanding gained from the course as well as exploring external peer-reviewed scientific resources.

Instructions: Students will submit the case study assignment (in APA format) online through the link provided on Blackboard. Further instructions will be provided in class as well as on the Blackboard.

If extenuating circumstances arise, and you are unable to meet the due date and time for an assignment, you must contact the course professor **prior** to that date/time. If you provide appropriate notice and/or a valid reason in advance of the due date, an extension **may** be negotiated between the student and the professor.

Any late assignments will be subject to the policies in the BScN Student Handbook. Additional regulations for assignments can be found in your BScN Student Handbook.

It is important that you keep any notes and rough work for any papers until the final mark for the course has been recorded. Please be sure to save electronic work frequently while working on an assignment.

Assignments are to be completed independently; this means by one student only. If you choose to work with a peer, and parts of your assignment are similar to the student with whom you worked, you will be risking plagiarism.

4. Title: Midterm test

Due Date: February 19, 2026, in-person during class time

Description: The midterm test will assess the learning outcomes from Chapters 18, 19, 20, 21, and 22. The length of the midterm will be 2 h long. The format of the midterm is as follows: 40 MCQ, 5 Select-all-that-apply (SATA) questions, short-answer questions (including labelling anatomical diagrams) (30 marks), and 1 physiology-related essay format question

(10 marks). The midterm test will be out of 85 marks and will be worth 30% of the overall course grade.

Instructions: The paper-based midterm test will be written in-person, in class, during class time. The midterm will be 2 h long. The answers to the MCQ and SATA questions should be marked on the test booklet as well as the Akindi sheet. All other answers should be written in the test booklet in the indicated space.

5. Title: Comprehensive Final Exam

Due Date: Week 14

Description: The comprehensive final exam will assess the learning outcomes from the entire course. However, the majority of the final exam will be on the content that you have not yet been assessed on (i.e., Chapters 23 - 27). The length of the final exam will be 2 h long. The format of the comprehensive final exam is as follows: 81 MCQ and 9 Select-all-that-apply (SATA) questions. The comprehensive final exam will be out of 90 marks and will be worth 35% of the overall course grade.

Instructions: The paper-based comprehensive final exam will be written during Week 14 in a classroom. The final exam schedule will be posted after Reading week. The answers to the MCQ and SATA questions should be marked on the test booklet as well as the Akindi sheet.

Weekly Flow

Week	Content	Readings Textbook: OpenStax Anatomy and Physiology
1	Introduction to the course Blood • Overview • Composition of blood • Plasma • Formed elements of blood • Blood types • Hemostasis	Syllabus Chapter 18
2	Heart • Anatomy • Electrical conduction system • The cardiac cycle • Cardiac physiology	Chapter 19
3	Blood vessels • Anatomy of arteries and veins • Major arteries and veins • Capillary exchange • Circulatory pathways • Blood pressure regulation Assessment: Quiz 1 (Due Date: January 25, 2026, at 2359)	Chapter 20 Chapters 18 and 19
4	Respiratory System • Anatomy of the upper and lower respiratory tract • Anatomy of the lungs • Ventilation • Gas exchange • Transport of gases • Respiratory physiology	Chapter 22

5 and 6	Lymphatic and Immune Systems • Anatomy • Functions of the lymphatic system • Innate immune system: components and their respective functions • Adaptive immune system: components and their respective functions Assessment: Quiz 2 (Due Date: February 8, 2026, at 2359) Assessment: Quiz 3 (Due Date: February 15, 2026, at 2359)	Chapter 21 Chapter 20 Chapters 21 and 22
7	Assessment: Midterm test (February 19, 2026), in person, in the classroom	Chapters 18, 19, 20, 21, and 22
Reading week		
8	Digestive System • Anatomy of the various digestive organs • Functions of the digestive organs • Physiology of the digestive system • Chemical digestion Assessment: Physiology Assignment (Due Date: March 8, 2026, at 2359)	Chapter 23
9	Metabolism and Nutrition • Metabolic reactions • Carbohydrate metabolism • Lipid metabolism • Protein metabolism • Basal metabolic rate • Nutrition and diet	Chapter 24
10	Urinary System • Gross and microscopic anatomy • The nephron • The glomerulus and the regulation of GFR	Chapters 25

	- Filtration, reabsorption, and secretion in the nephron - Physiology of urine formation and excretion - Other physiological process associated with the urinary system	
11	Fluid, Electrolyte, and Acid-Base Balance - Body fluids and compartments - Water balance - Electrolyte balance - Acid-base balance Assessment: Quiz 4 (Due Date: March 29, 2026, 2359)	Chapter 26 Chapters 23 and 24
12	Reproductive System - Anatomy of the male and female reproductive system - Physiology of the male reproductive system - Physiology of the female reproductive system Assessment: Case Study Assignment (Due Date: April 5, 2026, 2359)	Chapter 27
13	Review Assessment: Quiz 5 (Due Date: April 12, 2026, at 2359)	Chapters 25, 26, and 27
14	Assessment: Comprehensive Final Exam	All chapters listed above but the emphasis will be on Chapters 23 - 27

*Due to unforeseen circumstances, this schedule may be adjusted as needed by faculty. Any changes will be communicated to all students in class and/or on Blackboard

In-person Class Cancellation Protocol

If the in-person class is cancelled by the college due to the weather (or other events) (see Syllabus addendum on p. 27), I will make every effort to hold a synchronous, virtual class online instead. If the in-person class is cancelled by myself due to illness, I will also make every effort to conduct a synchronous virtual class online instead. Instructions for attending the virtual class will be emailed to the students and posted as an announcement on Blackboard.

Professionalism and Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is a core value at Georgian College and a priority in all academic activities. Students are responsible for being aware of and demonstrating behaviour that is honest and ethical. Students are also expected to take responsibility for their own academic work, adhering to integrity standards for themselves and their program but also encouraging and cultivating a culture of integrity among their classmates.

There are many significant offenses that warrant academic misconduct. Plagiarism and cheating for instance are behaviors that pose strong concern for student success. For further elaboration on behaviors of Academic Misconduct, refer to the Academic Calendar, Section 8.0 on [Academic Misconduct](#)).

Expectations

The HBSN program embraces a philosophy of equity, diversity, and inclusiveness in all interactions. A positive learning environment is integral to learning. Please refer to the [Student Code of Conduct](#) and program handbook for further information.

Student Assistance and Accommodations

If you require further assistance with your learning, please discuss it with your faculty, and/or seek assistance from Student Services. Information about Student Services and useful resources will be posted on your Semester 1 Blackboard organization and are also available on the College website. A good person to start with is your Student Advisor <http://www.georgiancollege.ca/student-life/student-services/student-advising/>

The student advisor for the HBSN program is Teddy Walsh (StudentSuccessAdvisorTeddyWalsh@georgiancollege.onmicrosoft.com). Please contact the advisor if you need assistance with your learning that is not related to the course content (e.g., study habits, time management, etc.)

If personal difficulties such as depression, anxiety, or other problems are affecting your ability to learn, please make an appointment with a counselor in Student Services <https://www.georgiancollege.ca/student-life/student-services/counselling/>. These services are free and completely confidential and can assist you in being a successful student.

Please do not wait until it is too late in the semester to seek assistance. The sooner you can make use of available resources, the better your chance of success. There is no reason not to consider the many services offered to you at Georgian College.

Maximizing your Grade

Make use of the College resources to help you become a better student. Georgian College has a wide variety of resources and support staff to help you become a more effective student. If you experience any difficulty with studying, writing tests or learning course material, consider making an appointment - [Contact the Library - Academic Success - Library and Academic Success at Georgian College](#)

Chapter Learning Outcomes

Chapter 18 (Blood) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Describe the composition and physical characteristics of whole blood.
3. Describe the functions of blood.
4. Discuss the composition and functions of plasma.
5. Describe the structure, function, and production of erythrocytes.
6. Describe the chemical composition, structure, and function of hemoglobin.
7. Describe the classes and functions of leukocytes.
8. Describe the function and structure of platelets.
9. Describe hemostasis.
10. Describe the ABO and Rh blood groups. Explain the basis of blood transfusions.

Required Readings: Chapter 18

Chapter 19 (Heart) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Describe the anatomy (size, shape, location, and orientation) of the heart in the thorax.
3. Describe the structure and function of each of the three layers of the heart wall.
4. Describe the structure and functions of the four heart chambers. Identify each chamber and provide the name and general route of its associated great vessels.
5. Name the heart valves and describe their location, function, and mechanism of operation.
6. Trace the pathway of blood through the heart.
7. Name the major branches of the coronary arteries.
8. Describe the structural and functional properties of cardiac muscle and explain how it differs from skeletal muscle.
9. Name the components of the conduction system of the heart and trace the conduction pathway.
10. Draw a diagram of a normal electrocardiogram (ECG) tracing. Name the individual waves and indicate what each represents.
11. Describe normal heart sounds and what they represent.
12. Describe, in detail, the timing and events of the cardiac cycle.
13. Name and explain the effects of factors regulating stroke volume and heart rate.
14. Explain the role of the autonomic nervous system and hormones in regulating cardiac output.

Required Readings: Chapter 19

Chapter 20 (Blood Vessels) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Describe the three layers that typically form the wall of a blood vessel and state the function of each.
3. Define vasoconstriction and vasodilation.
4. Compare and contrast the structure and function of the three types of arteries.
5. Describe the structure and function of a capillary bed.
6. Describe the structure and function of veins and explain how veins differ from arteries.
7. Define blood flow, blood pressure, and resistance, and explain the relationships between these factors.
8. Describe how blood pressure differs in the arteries, capillaries, and veins.
9. List and explain the factors that influence blood pressure and describe how blood pressure is regulated.
10. Explain how blood flow is regulated in the body in general and in specific organs.
11. Outline the factors involved in capillary exchange dynamics and explain the significance of each.
12. Trace the pathway of blood through the pulmonary circuit and state the importance of this special circulation.
13. Name and locate the major arteries and veins in the systemic circulation.
14. Describe the structure and special function of the hepatic portal system.

Required Readings: Chapter 20

Chapter 22 (The Respiratory System) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Identify the organs forming the respiratory system.
3. List and describe several protective mechanisms of the respiratory system.
4. Distinguish between conducting and respiratory zone structures.
5. Describe the makeup of the respiratory membrane and relate its structure to function.
6. Describe the gross structure of the lungs and pleurae.
7. Explain the functional importance of the partial vacuum (negative pressure) that exists in the pleural cavity.
8. Explain the pressure changes during ventilation.
9. Explain and compare the various lung volumes and capacities; explain spirometry testing.
10. Describe how atmospheric and alveolar air differ in composition and explain these differences.
11. Describe how oxygen is transported in blood and explain how temperature, pH and carbon dioxide affect oxygen loading and unloading from hemoglobin.
12. Describe carbon dioxide transport in the blood.
13. Briefly describe the neural controls of respiration.
14. Compare and contrast the influences of arterial partial pressures of oxygen and carbon dioxide on respiratory rate and depth.

Required Readings: Chapter 22

Chapter 21 (The Lymphatic and Immune System) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Describe the general functions of the lymphatic system.
3. Describe the structure and distribution of lymphatic vessels.
4. Describe the source of lymph and mechanism(s) of lymph transport.
5. Describe the cellular population of lymphoid tissue.
6. Describe the general location, histological structure, and functions of lymph nodes.
7. Name and describe the other lymphoid organs of the body. Compare and contrast them with lymph nodes, structurally and functionally.
8. Describe surface membrane barriers and their protective functions.
9. Describe the innate immune system and its various components.
10. Explain the importance of phagocytosis and natural killer cells in the innate defenses.
11. Name two of the body's antimicrobial substances and describe their function.
12. Describe the adaptive immune system and its various components.
13. Define an antigen and describe how antigens affect the adaptive defenses.
14. Compare and contrast the origin, maturation process, and general functions of B and T lymphocytes.
15. Define immunocompetence and self-tolerance and describe their development in B and T lymphocytes.
16. Name several antigen-presenting cells and describe their roles in adaptive defenses.
17. Describe humoral immunity.
18. Explain the roles of naïve B cells, plasma cells and memory B cells in humoral immunity.
19. Compare and contrast active and passive humoral immunity.
20. Explain how antibodies inactivate antigens.
21. Describe cellular immunity and describe the process of activation and clonal selection of T cells.
22. Describe the roles and functions of the different types of T cells.
23. Compare and contrast the innate versus adaptive immune systems.

Required Readings: Chapter 21

Chapter 23 (The Digestive System) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Describe the gross and microscopic anatomy of the various organs in the digestive system.
3. Describe the location and function of the peritoneum.
4. Describe the importance of the hepatic portal system.
5. Describe the tissue composition and general function of the layers of the various digestive organs.
6. Describe the composition and functions of saliva and explain how salivation is regulated.
7. Identify structural modifications of the wall of the stomach that enhance the digestive process.
8. Name the cell types responsible for secreting the various components of gastric juice and indicate the importance of each component in stomach activity.
9. Explain how gastric secretion and stomach motility are regulated.
10. Identify and describe structural modifications of the wall of the small intestine that enhance the digestive process.
11. Describe the function of gastric and intestinal hormones.
12. Describe the micro- and macroscopic anatomy of the liver and the biliary system.
13. Describe the role of the gallbladder and the secretion of bile.
14. Describe secretion and the role of pancreatic juice in digestion.
15. Describe how bile and pancreatic juice secretion into the small intestine are regulated.
16. Describe the major functions of the large intestine.
17. Describe the physiology of chemical digestion of carbohydrates, proteins, and lipids.
18. Briefly describe how the end-products of chemical digestion are absorbed in the small intestine.

Required Readings: Chapter 23

Chapters 24 (Metabolism and Nutrition) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Briefly describe the metabolism of carbohydrates.
3. Briefly describe the metabolism of proteins.
4. Briefly describe the metabolism of lipids.
5. Briefly describe the basal metabolic rate.
6. Identify and describe the roles of the essential vitamins and minerals required as part of a well-balanced diet.
7. Briefly identify the important components of a well-balanced diet based on the Canada Food Guide.

Required Readings: Chapter 24

Chapter 25 (The Urinary System) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Describe the gross anatomy of the kidney and its coverings.
3. Trace the blood supply through the kidney.
4. Describe the structure of the nephron.
5. Describe the forces (pressures) that promote or counteract glomerular filtration.
6. Describe the control and regulation of the glomerular filtration rate (GFR).
7. Describe the mechanisms underlying water and solute reabsorption from the renal tubules into the peritubular capillaries.
8. Describe how sodium and water reabsorption is regulated in the distal tubule and collecting duct.
9. Describe the importance of tubular secretion and list several substances that are secreted.
10. Explain the formation of dilute versus concentrated urine.
11. Describe the normal physical and chemical properties of urine.
12. Describe the general location, structure, and function of the ureters.
13. Describe the general location, structure, and function of the male and female urinary bladder.
14. Describe the general location, structure, and function of the male and female urethra.

Required Readings: Chapter 25

Chapter 26 (Fluid, Electrolyte, and Acid-Base Balance) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. List the factors that determine body water content and describe the effect of each factor.
3. Indicate the relative fluid volume and solute composition of the fluid compartments of the body.
4. List the routes by which water enters and leaves the body.
5. Describe feedback mechanisms that regulate water intake and hormonal controls of water output in urine.
6. Explain the importance of obligatory water losses.
7. Indicate routes of electrolyte entry and loss from the body.
8. Describe the importance of sodium in the body's fluid and electrolyte balance and indicate its relationship to normal cardiovascular system functioning.
9. Describe mechanisms involved in regulating sodium balance, blood volume, and blood pressure.
10. Briefly explain how potassium and calcium concentration in plasma are regulated.
11. List important sources of acids in the body.
12. List the three major chemical buffer systems of the body and describe how they resist pH changes.
13. Describe the influence of the respiratory system on acid-base balance.
14. Describe how the kidneys regulate hydrogen and bicarbonate ion concentrations in the blood.

Required Readings: Chapter 26

Chapter 27 (The Reproductive System) Learning Outcomes

1. Utilize appropriate medical and nursing terminology.
2. Describe the structure and function of the testes and explain the importance of their location in the scrotum.
3. Describe the location, structure, and function of the other reproductive organs of the male reproductive system.
4. Briefly outline the events of spermatogenesis.
5. Discuss hormonal regulation of testicular function and the physiological effects of testosterone on the male reproductive system.
6. Describe the location, structure, and function of the ovaries.
7. Describe the location, structure, and function of each of the other organs of the female reproductive system.
8. Discuss the structure and function of the mammary glands.
9. Describe ovarian cycle phases and relate them to events of oogenesis.
10. Describe the regulation of the ovarian and uterine/menstrual cycles.
11. Discuss the physiological effects of the various hormones on the ovarian and uterine/menstrual cycle.

Required Readings: Chapter 27